using Adobe Flash or other browser plugins. Although Adobe's Flash player is unquestionably the most ubiquitous of these, most developers and designers would agree that it's better not to rely on a plugin at all. One of the most exciting and long-awaited features in HTML5 is the <audio> element, enabling native audio playback within the browser. The audio element APIs allows you to access control and manipulate timeline data and network states of the files.

The audio tag is supported by nearly all of the major browsers. For browsers that don't support audio natively you can always fallback to Flash.

The Spec

Currently, the HTML5 spec defines five attributes for the <audio> element:

src — a valid <abbr>URL</abbr> specifying the content source.

autoplay — a boolean specifying whether the file should play as soon as it can.

loop — a boolean specifying whether the file should be repeatedly played.

controls — a boolean specifying whether the browser should display its default media controls.

preload — none / metadata / auto — where 'metadata' means preload just the metadata and 'auto' leaves the browser to decide whether to preload the whole file.

Let's create a simple example that will play an audio file:

```
<audio src="elvis.ogg" controls preload="auto" auto-buffer></audio>
```

This table details the codecs supported by today's browsers:

To create your own controls, you can use the API methods defined by the spec:

- play() — plays the audio
- pause() — pauses the audio
- canPlayType() — interrogates the browser to establish whether the given mime type can be played
- buffered() — attribute that specifies the start and end time of the buffered part of the file

The source

The best way to force the browsers into playing audio is to use the <source> element. The browser will try to load the first audio source, and if it fails